

Video On Linux

Q I have an Intel Pentium IV 1.80 GHz with 128 MB of RAM and a 40 GB Maxtor hard disk. I have two OSes installed on my PC—Windows XP Professional SP2 and Fedora Core Linux 2. I downloaded the Mplayer.tar file from www.mplayerhq.hu and tried to install it on Linux, but am unable to do so. How do I play video files in Fedora?

Krishna Gaire

A Here's how to install MPlayer on Linux: download the MPlayer code tarball from www.mplayerhq.hu/homepage/design7/dload.html to a temporary folder. Open the command window by typing "Konsole" in the Run dialog box. Uncompress the tar.bz2 file by typing in the following commands:

```
su
(Enter the root password when prompted)
```

```
tar -jxvf (Filename).tar.bz2
```

Change to the temporary folder where you just extracted the files, and enter the following commands.

```
./configure --enable-gui
make
make install
```

Without the `--enable-gui` switch, you will get a command line player. For GUI mode, you will need to download MPlayer skins from the MPlayer download page, and extract them to `/usr/local/share/mplayer/Skin`.

For DVD playback, download and extract the Subtitle Pack to the above location. MPlayer lacks DVD menus, and you'll have to manually choose title numbers, chapters and audio streams. Xine multimedia player from <http://xinehq.de> and Ogle from www.dtek.chalmers.se/groups/dvd are good alternatives for MPlayer, and have a much better GUI and features.

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cite the reason for re-installing Windows. Once you type in the confirmation ID, activation will be complete.

If you do not wish to re-activate XP, there is a way to back up the activation and restore it when you re-install XP. Follow these steps:

1 Navigate to the `%windir%\System32` folder and locate the 'wpa.dbf' and 'wpa.bak' files, and copy them to a safe location.

2 When you re-install XP, boot into Safe Mode by pressing [F8] at boot time.

3 Navigate to the `%windir%\System32` folder and rename the files 'wpa.dbf' and 'wpa.bak' to 'wpaold.dbf' and 'wpaold.bak' respectively. Copy the 'wpa.dbf' and 'wpa.bak' files from the previous Windows installation to this location. Windows XP will be activated when you reboot.

Note that this procedure will not work if you've made significant changes to the computer hardware, or if you're trying to install XP on another computer.

All Topsy-Turvy!

Q I have a Pentium IV 2.8 GHz on a motherboard with onboard Intel Extreme Graphics. A few days ago, my niece accidentally pressed some keys, and now the display is upside down! What can I do to set it straight?

Amit Shah

A The display got inverted because your niece accidentally pressed the hotkey combination that inverts the Intel Extreme Graphics adapter's display. To set it straight again, press [Ctrl] + [Alt] + [Up]. To disable rotation, right click the Intel Extreme Graphics icon on the taskbar, select 'Graphics Options', and then 'Graphics Properties'. Click on the 'Rotation' tab and remove the checkmark from the 'Enable rotation' box.

Alternatively, this can be accessed from Display Properties > Settings > Advanced > Intel Extreme Graphics > Graphics Properties.



Spanning A Backup

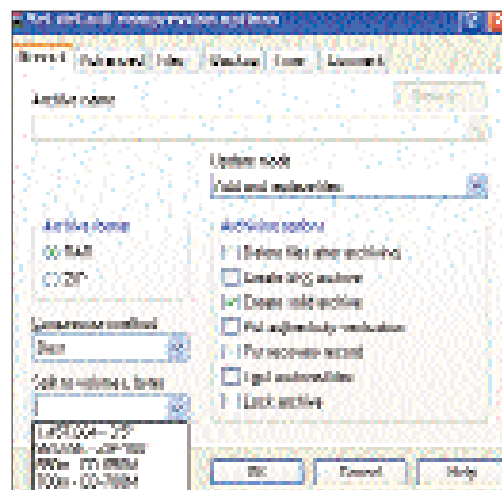
Q I took a backup of my C drive, and the size is 9.72 GB. I have a DVD-Writer, and the space available on a DVD is 4.72 GB. I would like to copy my backup file to DVDs.

Glenn Phillips

A Most file archiving utilities are capable of spanning archives across volumes of specified sizes. WinRAR and WinZip are two such. Let's use WinRAR: install it from www.rarsoft.com. Open Windows Explorer and right-click on the backup file you created. Click 'Add to archive...'. Choose a name for the archive and set the compression parameters according to what you want. Let the archive type remain as RAR, and select 'Create SFX archive' if you wish to create a self-extracting archive, using which you'll be able to extract the archive even without installing WinRAR. In the 'Split

Get Help Now!

E-mail us your computing problems along with your contact details and complete system configuration to sos@jasubhai.com, and we might answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!



Use WinRAR to span an archive across DVDs

to volumes, bytes' dialog box, set the volume size to 4,500,000,000 and click OK. Volumes of 4291 MB each will be created, and you can write these to individual DVDs. ■